Project Charter

Project Name	Pet4Life
Project Sponsor	Professor Chrisman, University of Louisville
Project Owner	Pet4Life
Project Manager	Maddy Schroth, University of Louisville

Charter Introduction

Revision History

Revision #	Revision Date	Description of Change	Author
1.0	09/17/2025	Added blogpost page features for liking, sharing, and admin content management.	Derby Devs
2.0	09/17/2025	Implemented sharing options for X and Facebook posts on blog page.	Derby Devs
3.0	09/17/2025	Created blog automation allowing administrators to update and add new posts.	Derby Devs
4.0	09/17/2025	Developed Petcare Hub page to provide users with PDF links for resources.	Derby Devs
5.0	10/05/2025	Built volunteer interest form for candidates to register through PlanHero.	Derby Devs
6.0	10/05/2025	Configured volunteer management system to allow users to sign up for opportunities.	Derby Devs
7.0	10/05/2025	Enabled volunteer availability updates for flexible scheduling.	Derby Devs
8.0	10/05/2025	Added options for one-time or recurring volunteer roles.	Derby Devs
9.0	10/05/2025	Set up notifications and reminders for upcoming volunteer events.	Derby Devs
10.0	10/05/2025	Required volunteer profile creation for PlanHero registration.	Derby Devs
11.0	10/05/2025	Developed event scheduling functionality for coordinators to create and edit events.	Derby Devs
12.0	10/05/2025	Added viewable list of upcoming volunteer events with details.	Derby Devs
13.0	10/05/2025	Implemented volunteer registration system for events.	Derby Devs
14.0	10/15/2025	Enhanced chatbot to direct users to contact page when needed.	Derby Devs

15.0	10/15/2025	Added chatbot option for administrators to access form submissions.	Derby Devs
16.0	10/29/2025	Implemented testimonials section on donations page to display pre-approved posts.	Derby Devs
17.0	10/29/2025	Added “Share Now” feature for submitting new testimonials.	Derby Devs
18.0	10/29/2025	Integrated WPForms Testimonial Form for community submissions.	Derby Devs
19.0	10/29/2025	Enabled admin approval system for managing submitted testimonials.	Derby Devs
20.0	10/29/2025	Built “Other Ways to Give” section with Wishlist and Kroger links.	Derby Devs
21.0	10/29/2025	Linked Amazon Wishlist to Pets4Life account for item donations.	Derby Devs
22.0	10/29/2025	Added admin capability to update Amazon Wishlist URL.	Derby Devs
23.0	10/29/2025	Created Kroger Community Rewards informational section.	Derby Devs
24.0	10/29/2025	Linked Kroger Rewards button to official registration portal.	Derby Devs
25.0	10/29/2025	Added admin editing capability for Kroger Rewards information.	Derby Devs
26.0	10/29/2025	Designed event listing feature showing upcoming community events.	Derby Devs
27.0	10/29/2025	Configured Amelia Lite plugin to allow event registration.	Derby Devs
28.0	10/29/2025	Added confirmation display after successful event registration.	Derby Devs
29.0	10/29/2025	Planned waitlist and cancellation options for future release.	Derby Devs
30.0	10/29/2025	Created customer profile functionality for storing user and pet data.	Derby Devs
31.0	10/29/2025	Enabled profile update option for users through Amelia panel.	Derby Devs
32.0	10/29/2025	Outlined feature for linking pets to events in future update.	Derby Devs
33.0	10/29/2025	Developed contact form allowing users to submit inquiries.	Derby Devs
34.0	10/29/2025	Added confirmation message after successful contact form submission.	Derby Devs
35.0	10/29/2025	Implemented mission partner form for organizational submissions.	Derby Devs
36.0	10/29/2025	Integrated WPForms Mission Partner Form with name, email, and phone fields.	Derby Devs
37.0	10/29/2025	Added general “Donate” button linking to WPForms donation form.	Derby Devs

38.0	10/29/2025	Configured donation form to collect donor name, message, and amount.	Derby Devs
39.0	10/29/2025	Added sponsor feature allowing users to support pets via donation form.	Derby Devs
40.0	11/05/2025	Developed chatbot administrative controls for managing predefined responses.	Derby Devs
41.0	11/12/2025	Enhanced chatbot interface for user assistance and improved conversation flow.	Derby Devs
42.0	11/19/2025	Configured chatbot to incorporate data from external sources.	Derby Devs
43.0	11/18/2025	Conducted chatbot integration testing with contact form redirection.	Derby Devs
44.0	11/20/2025	Finalized system documentation and prepared for Demo 3 presentation.	Derby Devs
45.0	11/26/2025	Completed final testing of site-wide user flows and verification checks.	Derby Devs

Executive Summary

Provide a brief overview of the purpose, results, and conclusions of this Project Charter condensed for the quick reading of an executive or manager. Summarize the project's costs, timeline, deliverables, and results.

This project charter has been developed with the Pets4Life project as well as necessities in mind. The project will require all costs associated with WordPress, the domain associated with the account, and any WordPress plugins our team decides to implement on Pets4Life's behalf. Our group plans on having this project done by the last week of the University of Louisville fall semester, which should be ending by December 4th, 2025. This is a hard deadline, so scope must be set accordingly and accurately for correct implementation of the project. Our team plans on delivering a fully functional project with platforms associated with volunteer management, event scheduling, donation management, and other key pieces of data that will be clarified later in the project. The results of these constraints, assumptions, and dependencies will be further clarified later in the project.

Project Authorization

This project charter formally authorizes the existence of the project, [Insert Project Name], and provides the Project Manager with the authority to apply organizational resources to project activities described herein. If there is a change in the project scope, the project charter will be updated and submitted for re-approval by the undersigned.

_____ _____

[Insert Name and Title] Date

Project Sponsor

_____ _____

[Insert Name and Title] Date

Project Owner

_____ _____

[Insert Name and Title] Date

Project Manager

_____ _____

[Insert Name and Title] Date

[Insert role of additional signees as needed]

Project Objective

Current Situation

Pets4Life Louisville is a nonprofit that helps families keep pets in their homes rather than surrendering them to shelters. While they provide low-cost clinics, outreach, and pet resources, they face significant barriers. Many families cannot afford even low-cost services, 71% of surveyed clients lack reliable transportation, and over one-third report a disability

Pets4Life is also overwhelmed by administrative burdens. They rely on fragmented tools like Google Sheets, Calendly, and SignUpGenius, which require manual data entry and offer little integration. This makes it difficult to schedule clinics, track volunteers, manage donations, or report data to stakeholders and grant providers

Business Need

To sustain its mission, Pets4Life needs a centralized, cost-effective, and low-maintenance web platform that automates critical functions. These include donation processing, volunteer management, clinic and event scheduling with automated reminders, and a Customer Service Hub to reduce the flood of emails, phone calls, and Facebook messages. The solution must be low-code, maintainable by non-technical staff, and capable of integrating with existing data sources like Airtable. By reducing manual coordination and providing better tools for donors, volunteers, and clients, Pets4Life can redirect staff time toward mission-critical services and strengthen its ability to secure and manage grants.

Approach

Project Description

The project will deliver a WordPress-based system configured with supported plugins and light integrations. Core capabilities will include secure online donations with receipts, volunteer sign-up and hour tracking, event and clinic scheduling integrated with Airtable, a chatbot-powered Customer Service Hub with ticket escalation, and staff-managed content updates. Where possible, automation (for example, Zapier or plugin workflows) will be used to reduce manual data entry and ensure information flows between forms, Airtable, and reporting. The solution will be built with sustainability in mind, ensuring Pets4Life staff can update and maintain the platform after handoff.

Goals

- Provide a unified site that consolidates core functions and reduces reliance on fragmented tools.
- Increase online donations through a smoother, more visible donation process including Sponsor-a-Pet campaigns and recurring donation options.
- Streamline volunteer coordination with an integrated calendar, sign-ups, and automated hour tracking.

- Reduce administrative load by automating clinic sign-ups and reminders.
- Establish a Customer Service Hub that filters common inquiries through a chatbot and escalates unresolved requests to a help ticket system.
- Improve data accuracy and reporting to support grant requirements and board oversight.
- Ensure accessibility, mobile responsiveness, and cost-effectiveness.

Objectives

- Deploy donation, volunteer, scheduling, and customer support features within the WordPress framework.
- Eliminate redundant manual entry by integrating online forms with Airtable databases for pets, families, and volunteers.
- Replace SignUpGenius and Calendly with plugin-based alternatives that tie directly into the platform.
- Launch a chatbot for FAQs and service triage with ticket escalation for more complex requests.
- Deliver at least three exportable reports including donation summaries, volunteer hours by event, and clinic attendance.
- Provide a one-page quick reference for managing events, donations, and volunteer records.
- Meet baseline nonfunctional requirements including SSL, backups, uptime monitoring, and accessibility features such as alt text, contrast, and keyboard navigation.

Success Criteria & Measures

Success Criteria & Measures

The following criteria will be used to measure project success. The current state reflects existing conditions, and the target state defines the desired outcome upon project completion.

Success Criteria	Current State	Target State
Website usability & navigation	The website is outdated and not optimized for multiple user groups.	Redesigned site with intuitive navigation supporting pet families, volunteers, donors, and staff.
Donation Process	Donations are not fully integrated or easy to manage/use.	Streamlined online donation system (GiveWP) with recurring donations and clear reporting.
Volunteer Management	Volunteer sign-ups and tracking are inconsistent across platforms.	Centralized system (PlanHero) for sign-ups, calendar integration, and hours tracking.
Chatbot Support	No automated support, staff must handle all FAQs manually.	Chatbot (Lyro) answers FAQs, escalates when needed, and improves response efficiency.
Data Integration	Information is spread across multiple platforms, creating integrity issues.	Centralized database (Airtable) with organized volunteer, donor, and event data.
Project Milestones	No current deliverables completed.	Meet milestones: 50% by Demo 1 (Oct. 13) 75% by Demo 2 (Nov. 3) 100% by Final Delivery (Dec. 4)

Scope

In Scope

This scope of work will include the key components that the client would like to see in the new website. This will include, but not be limited to:

I. Easy navigation of website
   a. The website will be serving four different audiences including: Pet families, Volunteers, Donors/Supporters, and Core team members. The website must accommodate all of these groups
   b. Branding and Aesthetic: Our group plans on conforming to that of the Pets4Life original web design, along with incorporating a similar color palette. This will ensure clear branding of the company, staying true to values, along with easy navigation with compelling stories

c. Homepage specifically will be welcoming with the ribbon at the top with Pets4Life pictures of success stories along with any other pieces of information wanted in the ribbon. Also, the mission and values will be included on the homepage to bring an emotional and human look to the company's practices.

II. Chatbot
   a. Our team plans on using Tidio's knowledge based chatbot, Lyro, to help answer frequently asked questions and other pieces of information that a user might need. This will increase accessibility to information for the users when the human representatives aren't online.
   b. Escalation: Lyro can be instructed to have an escalation point if the question or issue is beyond what the chatbot can do. This can include directions to a contact form or something of the sort for a human representative to reach out to them and contact them with the right information.
   c. Guidance: Our team will be able to program the AI's tone, language use, and other key pieces of information to ensure that all users are happy with the chatbot and the information it is giving.

III. Volunteer Management
   a. Signups will be managed through PlanHero, an application that will manage events for volunteering and volunteers as well. This will integrate with any volunteer's personal calendar and will help for easy use of the system.
   b. Volunteer Profiles: PlanHero will also allow for volunteer hour tracking and profiles to an extent. This will keep the data all in one place and allow for simple management by the volunteers and Pets4Life employees.

IV. Donations
   a. WPForms Pro can be used to manage general donations. It supports one-time and recurring donations through payment integrations like Stripe or PayPal. This will allow donors to submit contributions directly through the website.
   b. WPForms Pro forms are fully customizable; the same donation form can include an option to "Sponsor a Pet" by adding fields such as pet name, pet ID, or sponsor category. If preferred for better organization or reporting, a separate form can also be created specifically for pet sponsorships.
   c. Page on Ribbon: our group plans on designing the donation page with success stories that our staff have access to from families who have used Pets4Life's services. This helps with user engagement and will hopefully compel more people to donate.

V. Event Management
   a. Our team plans on using Amelia pro plugin for Event scheduling. This platform can accept stripe payments which will integrate all in one account, overall simplifying the process and therefore helping the stakeholders.

VI. Design of databases: As of right now, this will be updated as the project progresses, but all data will be collected throughout the various platforms and then translated to Airtable, the chosen platform for data integration. Specific databases will be assigned for all stakeholders along with the necessary actions associated with each.

VII. Contact us: for escalation, along with any other necessities, including job information or any other single instance issues, a contact us form can be integrated into the

website for easy access. This is something that can be integrated using WPForms and can be directed to an email.

VIII. Community engagement: Will include a testimonial form to allow supporters to share their experiences with Pets4Life. This enhances user engagement, provides authentic stories that strengthen trust, and supports the organization's mission.

Out of Scope

The out-of-scope section will include any extra wants that were mentioned by Pets4Life that might not be manageable during the scope of the project due to time, cost, or integration purposes. These, if time or cost permitting, still could be introduced to the project, but are not included in the main scope. These exclusions are:

I. Transport volunteer matching: Due to integration issues with other volunteer platforms and the data integrity of the platform, transport volunteer matching will not be in scope for this project at this time.

II. Event/Volunteer Waitlist: With the platforms that we picked, along with the cost associated with this feature, our group is unsure that a waitlist for events or volunteering is in scope. When truly getting into the plugin, this is out of scope.

III. Chatbot paw print icon: Due to the cost of adding a paw print icon for the chatbot, it is out of budget.

Scope Management Plan

Purpose

The purpose of this Scope Management Plan is to outline how the project scope was defined, verified, and controlled throughout each project phase. This plan ensures that all deliverables for the Pets4Life Web Development Project align with the client’s requirements and objectives while preventing scope creep or unnecessary changes.

Scope Definition

The project scope was initially defined in the Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) and refined through the work packages identified in the Project Management Plan. These work packages served as checkpoints for validating the completion of each major deliverable. The primary focus of the project included event scheduling, volunteer management, donations, chatbot integration, and contact form automation. The work packages were used to ensure all features aligned with the established requirements and client feedback.

Scope Planning Approach

The project team used the work packages as a framework to manage and verify scope throughout each development phase. During the early stages, the team focused on defining requirements, setting up WordPress, selecting the appropriate plugins, and confirming goals with the client. The design and development phases involved translating the RTM requirements into functional components such as the donation system, volunteer sign-up process, and blog layout.

The demo cycles allowed the team to address client feedback and make necessary scope adjustments. For example, after Demo 1, the team refined the color scheme and navigation for better accessibility and user experience. After Demo 2, the event scheduling and volunteering functions were finalized using Amelia Lite, and the chatbot was completed and tested during the final iteration.

The final phase focused on quality assurance, verifying that all deliverables aligned with the approved scope and that all functionality was working properly before project closure.

Major Scope Adjustments

A few adjustments were made to maintain alignment with the client's needs and system functionality. The team initially tested the Fillout plugin for event scheduling and volunteer management but reverted to Amelia pro after discovering that Fillout did not meet Pets4Life's requirements. This change ensured that the system supported the desired scheduling and booking features.

Additional refinements included improving the color consistency across all pages, standardizing the visual layout for accessibility, and finalizing the chatbot integration in the last iteration to align with the site's user flow.

Scope Verification

Scope verification occurred at each demo milestone. During these reviews, the project team validated that deliverables matched the requirements documented in the RTM. Feedback from the client and project sponsor was recorded and implemented in the following iteration. Each verification cycle confirmed that development work stayed aligned with project objectives and user expectations.

Scope Control

All scope changes were documented and reviewed before implementation. The RTM served as the central record for tracking updates and revisions. Unauthorized features or unapproved

changes were deferred for post-project evaluation. Only updates reviewed and approved by the project lead and sponsor were implemented. This process ensured that all modifications were justified, tested, and verified before final integration.

Key Deliverables

Major Task/Phase	Deliverables	Description	Due Dates (target)	Party Responsible
Project Initiation	• Team Charter • Kick-off minutes	Define roles, team rules, scope understanding.	Week 1 08/24	Team
Requirements Analysis	Draft RMP • Draft RTM • Meeting Minutes	Gather and documents requirements, validate with stakeholders.	Week 2 09/02	Team
Project Definition	Draft SOW • Draft Project Charter • Draft PMP	Establish scope, objectives, and PM approach.	Week 3 09/07	Team

Requirements Finalization	Final RMP • Final RTM • Final SOW & PC	Lock in requirements and baseline documentation.	Week 4 09/14	Team
Sponsor Review	SOW Submitted to Sponsor	Share scope and deliverables with Pets4Life for feedback.	Week 5 09/17	Team
Architecture & Design	SAD • ERD • UFD	Define technical architecture, data model, and user flows.	Week 4-5 (09/14-09/21)	Team
Development Iteration 1	Core site pages (Homepages, About, Donation, Volunteer) • Screenshots of progress	Begin building must-have features in WordPress.	Week 6-8 (9/22-10/12)	Developers
Demo 1	Demo presentation (~50% complete) • Feedback log	Show stakeholders functioning prototype.	Week 9 (10/13)	Team
Development Iteration 2	Extended pages (Events, FAQ, Blog, Chatbot) • Updated RTM	Implement remaining features, address Demo 1 feedback.	Week 10-11 (10/20-11/02)	Developers
Demo 2	Demo presentation (~75% complete) • Feedback log	Present near-complete site and gather feedback.	Week 12 (11/03)	Team
Final Iteration & QA	Final RTM • Corrective actions • Progress reports	Implement fixes from Demo 2, finalize features.	Week 13-14 (11/10-11/23)	Team
Final Demo & Delivery	Final demo (~100% complete) • Final PPT • Final PMP • Final RTM • Handover package	Deploy completed site, deliver all course required docs.	Week 15 (11/24-12/08)	Team

Project Milestones

Milestone	Description	Expected Date
Requirements Finalized	Final RMP, RTM, SOW, PC	9/14
Sponsor Review of SOW	SOW submitted to sponsor	9/17

Demo 1	Present the project at 50% completeness	10/13/2025
Demo 2	Present the project at 75% completeness	11/03/2025
Demo 3	Present the project at 100% completeness	12/08/2025

Estimated Budget

Estimate the costs associated with implementing this process and how it will be funded.

Item	How funded	Amount
Domain Purchase	Derby Devs	$13
WordPress Domain Access	Derby Devs	$120
PlanHero Pro Plan	Derby Devs	$54
TOTAL		$187

Assumptions & Constraints

Assumptions

These assumptions will be validated during the planning process. Inaccurate, inconsistent, or incomplete assumptions result in project risks.

- Pets4life has data for pets, families, volunteers, clinic info that can be integrated into the new system.
- WordPress plugins selected for Pets4life will be affordable, actively maintained, effective, and compatible for the nonprofit to use.
- We will support SSL, backups, uptime monitoring, and accessibility requirements.

Constraints

Type of Constraint	Constraint Details
Low-Code Environment	The project we are delivering will be managed by non-technical staff. They must be able to update, add and change things, otherwise, the future for Pets4life is not sustainable.
Strict Deadlines	Each milestone must be met on the coordinated date, we cannot afford to miss those deadlines, due to the constraints of our project sponsor and our timeline. Which makes it necessary to not get out of scope and fall behind.

Limited Budget	Pets4life is a non-profit, they cannot afford unsustainable prices, so we must limit what tools we have access to for the development.
Security	Ensuring the safety and privacy of each of the user's information. It contains detailed medical information of the pets as well as personal information of the owners.

Risks

Likelihood of Risk Occurring	
0-10%	Rare
11-35%	Unlikely
36-65%	Possible
66-90%	Likely
91-100%	Almost Certain

Severity of Risk	
Low	No attention apart from monitoring
Moderate	Immediate Attention
Major	Manager to monitor; attention & review by Pillar head
High	Attention & review by Principal

Risk Description	**Likelihood**	**Severity**	**Mitigation Plan**
Not delivering milestones on time	Rare	Moderate	Make sure everyone is on the same page during team meetings and communicate when you need more help on a task. If, in the case, it does occur, we would then meet with our project sponsor to discuss our next course of action.
Data leak of user information	Rare	Major	We plan to avoid this by taking thorough record keeping and safe transferring of all the user data and making sure everything we use is completely safe. If it does occur, we will then go back to records, backtrack everything to find how it happened, report everything to our project sponsor.
Incorrect Integration of WordPress Plugins	Possible	Major	If this were to occur, our group would ensure we pick a 3rd party to help integrate the information or picking different plug-ins

Risk Description	Likelihood	Severity	Mitigation Plan
Scope Creep	Unlikely	Major	If this were to occur, the client might not recieve the components that are required for her business.We plan on ensuring all deliverables are on time, and that we also leave extra time at the end of the semester for corrections
Gold Plating	Unlikely	Moderate	If this would occur, it could cause scope creep. Our plan to migitate this is to worry about functionality prior to looks.

Dependencies

Identify the known dependencies in the table below.

Project	Description of Dependency	Timing
Pets4life	Continued availability of selected WordPress plugins and other features.	All Semester
Pets4life	Pets4Life leadership and project sponsor availability for milestone reviews and approvals.	All Semester
Pets4life	Timely migration of donors, pets, and volunteer data into the new platform to accommodate the needs of Pets4life.	All Semester

Project References

Identify and describe the location of the key documents that define and establish the project such as the business case, the 5-year Financial Plan, strategic plan, academic plan, etc.

Document Title	Date	Author(s) (individual or office)	Location (link or file path)

Project Glossary

Define all terms and acronyms required to interpret the project charter properly. Add rows as needed.

Term or Acronym	Definition